If you controlled Dark Eras 2...



Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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If you controlled Dark Eras 2...

#1
06-22-2015, 06:17 AM

Not that we'll know if it actually happens any time soon, but if you got to pick the chapters for Dark Eras 2, what would they be? One chapter for each major splat, plus one chapter for any blue book (which could be vanilla mortals too if you so wish).

Right now I've got Wild West Geist, Book of Judges Hunter, Xia Dynasty Beast, Rashidun Caliphate Mummy, Orient Express Vampire, Golden Age of Piracy Mage, Kipchack Werewolf, Industrial Revoution Demon, Zande Changeling, Inca Promethian, and Blitz Innocents as my picks.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

Tags: None

3

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glamourweaver

06-22-2015, 07:11 AM

#2

Vampire: Qin Dynasty (some crossover elements with Immortals)

Werewolf: World War I

Mage: Fall of the Mayan Empire

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Posts: 7541

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Promethean: English Civil War - 1666 (with the death of the last of the Belenus Lineage [Wickermen], the previous Fire/Choleric Lineage)

Changeling: 1850s Underground Railroad (ideally with a double-length expansion exploring a tie in through the Hedge with the Dahomey conflict with Abeokuta in West Africa)

Hunter: Founding of the Haudenosaunee (Iroquois League - new Conspiracy, the Sons of Sosondowah carry out the Great Law against dark magic, human sacrifice, and cannibal cults)

Geist: Dante's Italy (some crossover elements with Inferno)

Mummy: Height of the Incan Empire (a setting focused on a mysterious surge of Twice-Risen)

Demon: Wild West (sorry Geist, but the devil's bargains at crossroads, meets the search for a new life out west, while the God-Machine persues in the form of railroads and telegraph lines, is just too perfect)

Beast: Turn of the Century Tibet/Mongolia (contemporary to Ruins of Empire, with the decaying Chinese power, Russian expansion, and British adventurism during the reign of the 13th Dalai Lama)

Innocents in the Blitz

We should discuss crossover pitches too shouldn't we?

Check out my expansion to the Realm of Brass and Shadow

3

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06-22-2015, 07:23 AM #3

There is no guarantee it will happen at all. But here's hoping!

Will be back later with more ideas.

FallenEco

Member

Join Date: Dec 2013
Posts: 1926

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Thoughts ripple out, birthing others

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06-22-2015, 07:40 AM #4



Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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*Originally posted by **FallenEco***
There is no guarantee it will happen at all. But here's hoping!

Will be back later with more ideas.

No, never any guarantees... But it was pretty darn popular! I'd say that works in our favour

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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Krobeles
Member

Join Date: Jan 2014
Posts: 499

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06-22-2015, 08:30 AM #5

I would throw it to the curb, in favor of more interesting material set in current times, instead of making "what if" scenarioes in eras that nobody can relate to as easily.
Sorry if I sound a bit exasperated, but I never really understood the appeal of dark eras at all and frankly, I think its a waste of time and effort, especially for Geist, since it barely has any material in the first place.

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Tymeaus Jalynsfein
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 869

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06-22-2015, 08:38 AM #6

While I was a big supporter of the Dark Eras Product, I do tend to agree with you here. More modern...

The problem with defending the purity of the English language is that English is about as pure as a cribhouse whore. We don't just borrow words; on occasion, English has pursued other languages down alleyways to beat them unconscious and rifle their pockets for new vocabulary. - James. D. Nicoll

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glamourweaver
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 7541

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06-22-2015, 08:40 AM #7

> *Originally posted by* ***Krobeles***
> *instead of making "what if" scenarioes in eras that nobody can relate to as easily.*

Speak for yourself.

Check out my expansion to the Realm of Brass and Shadow

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Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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06-22-2015, 08:47 AM #8

> *Originally posted by* ***Krobeles***
> *I would throw it to the curb, in favor of more interesting material set in current times, instead of making "what if" scenarioes in eras that nobody can relate to as easily.*
> *Sorry if I sound a bit exasperated, but I never really understood the appeal of dark eras at all and frankly, I think its a waste of time and effort, especially for Geist, since it barely has any material in the first place.*

Hugely disagree. Geist had on of the best settings in the entire book, and I find pretty much everything to be highly relatable. If I can get on my teacher box for a second, the entire reason I argue to students that we should study is so that we can go through the experience of empathize get with others. I love it and the Dark Eras game concept so much precisely because it is so relatable. Hell, I'm planning to use some of the eras to teach my girlfriend about time periods she doesn't know about!

Now that being said, there are plenty of times in the last two centuries that I think would make excellent eras, many within living memory.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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06-22-2015, 08:48 AM #9



Krobeles
Member

Join Date: Jan 2014
Posts: 499

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*Originally posted by **glamourweaver***

Speak for yourself.

Are you suggesting you relate better to a historical period that you haven't lived in, than to the pressent day which you experience every second of every day??

Dont get me wrong, I didn't mean to say that nobody could relate to them at all. Merely that it wasn't quite as easy to relate to a period that nobody outside of a histories professor knows as intimately as they do contemporary times as it is to relate to current times.

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Second Chances
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 4201

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06-22-2015, 08:54 AM #10

*Originally posted by **Krobeles***

Are you suggesting you relate better to a historical period that you haven't lived in, than to the pressent day which you experience every second of every day??

Dont get me wrong, I didn't mean to say that nobody could relate to them at all. Merely that it wasn't quite as easy to relate to a period that nobody outside of a histories professor knows as intimately as they do contemporary times as it is to relate to current times.

Absolutely not, but I think you are underestimating how much people know about a given time period. Would Rome or The Borgias been such popular television if people couldn't relate to it? Absolutely not. By the same token, I can't easily relate to the experience of someone living the slums of Chicago or fighting for their life in Syria as I can with some historical figures. It cuts both ways.

Chris H/EndDaysEngine | **Patreon**| **He/His** | **Currently Writing**: *[Redacted], [Redacted]*

CofD booklists: Beast I Changeling | Demon | Deviant | Geist I Hunter I Mage | Mummy | Promethean | Vampire | Werewolf

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06-22-2015, 12:13 PM #11

Bear in mind that we got four “dark eras” before the Dark Eras project was originally conceived: Requiem for Rome, New Age Requiem, Mage Noir, and Victorian Changeling. While a Dark Eras 3 doesn't interest me (we're already getting a second Dark Eras book, from the spillover from the first one), I *would* be interested in the occasional “standalone dark era”. First and foremost, ere are a

Dataweaver
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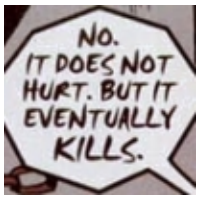
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few “close seconds”, dark eras that did really well in the voting, just not quite good enough. Old Testament Hunter, for instance.

My hacks: Trinity Continuum, Scion, Exalted, World of Darkness, Chronicles of Darkness

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Malkydel
Member

Join Date: Jan 2015
Posts: 112

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06-22-2015, 12:24 PM #12

Hunter: Wars of Scottish Independence

"The phrase 'flies on the heads of pins' appeared 43 times in that journal, sometimes in the middle of sentences or written in the margins."

1

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The Kings Raven
Member

Join Date: Nov 2013
Posts: 3003

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06-22-2015, 01:19 PM #13

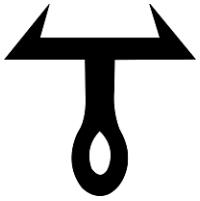
I'd love to see Hunter WWII as a whole set of dark eras. Britain would show the Vigil in a time of great turmoil; the apotheosis of the Union's creed of defending your little patch of light. Occupied France would take the minor "Hunter vs sinister Conspiracy" theme and go to town with it. The Western Front would be Conspiracy vs Conspiracy while the Eastern Front would be pure survivial horror where you play both German and Russian Conscripts - innocents thrown into a meat grinder while "General Winter" and monsters in the wilderness emerge to prey on the conflict.

The overall theme would be one of great change as plenty of Conspriacies are wiped out entirely and new ones are formed.

Speaking of which. I've started work on a Hunter - counterculture America that's a follow up to WWII as the destruction across mankind's occult communities leaves lore unguarded for anyone to find. I've got a section in the Canites & the Civil Rights movement; a section on feminism. Just need a section on the hippy movement and the smaller supporting pieces.

“There are no rules. Only Principles and natural laws.” - Promethius
My Homebrew no longer fits in a signature, you can find an index of it here.
Full length fan-books I contributed too: Princess: the Hopeful, Leviathan: the Tempest, Dream Catchers

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malonkey1
Member

Join Date: Dec 2014
Posts: 1620

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06-22-2015, 01:32 PM #14

I agree with Second here. Times and technology may change, but people are always people, and they can always be related to.

As for what I'd include in a second Dark Eras:

- Vampire: Reign of Terror (Post-revolutionary France) (possibly crossing with Hunter). The aristocracy is on the run, with the Invictus-led power structure buckling as Kindred society imitates the mortal bloodshed happening all around. The rebels have even begun to organize into a nascent covenant of their own, the earliest signs of the Carthian movement.
- Werewolf: New Wave Werewolf. Part expansion on New Wave Requiem, mostly its own thing. Despite movies like Teen Wolf, being a Werewolf in the 80s is still very serious business. The crack cocane epidemic, coupled with President Reagan's *severe* mishandling of the issue has created a storm of ecological turmoil in the Shadow across America. Arguably a broader sequel to Bowery Dogs
- Mage: The Age of Discovery. The world has become much larger for Europeans. With the enlightenment of the Renaissance and the broadening of the Western World's horizons, it seems like an excellent time for the Diamond Orders. However, the servants of the Exarchs can be found in all nations, and they aren't fond of visitors.
- Promethean: The Jungle (Industrial Revolution). The mid-1800's were a time of astounding technological progress, as consumer goods become cheap and plentiful, and people moved to cities where lucrative factory jobs awaited. Even the Created came to the cities, in the hope that running the machines and making things might offer insight on their pilgrimage. However, the Industrial Revolution was also a time of horrific abuses against the working class, and Prometheans suffer even worse. Features a Refinement centered around the use of technology to cure Promethean woes.
- Changeling: Darkest Africa (1600's Africa). The slave trade has been going for some time, with the white men paying nations for their prisoners of war, but slavery in Africa dates back much farther, as evil spirits steal away children to a bizarre land. What will those who escape do when they see the slave trade? And can they escape being enslaved once again, by man or spirit?
- Hunter: Bronze-Age Hunter. In a time of myth and legend. When the ancient gods were petty and cruel, and they plagued mankind with suffering, few had the strength to challenge their power. These people, who we would later call Hunters, were hailed as Heroes, protecting mankind from the predations of impossible monsters, deadly spirits, and sometimes, even the gods themselves. Possible Beast crossover.
- Geist: All the Glitters (California Gold Rush). The old saying "money makes the world go 'round," isn't entirely accurate. the truth is that *greed* is what keeps the world turning. Greed gives us the drive to hoard and store resources, to refine our techniques and get more resources, and to protect our resources from plundering and destruction. Obviously, greed can be a very dark force, turning brother against brother, friend against friend, and man against mankind. The deaths related to greed are so grievous and so many, that when a town is abandoned, the term "ghost town" becomes literal. Features the Gilded Key, a new Key linked to greed.
- Mummy: The Second Great War (WWII). You are awakened by your cult in a dark time. Perhaps your cult is besieged by Nazis, seeking your occult artifacts. Perhaps the Nazis have awoken you to *do* the besieging. Either way, there are items of value and power ripe for the taking. The question is whether the mortals will allow you to keep it.

- Demon: Imitation Machines (WWII). The other side of the conflict, far from the front. The God-Machine has been acting strange lately, even for *it*. It's been giving angels nonsense orders, setting free captured Demons, and a mysterious, extremely long string of letters and numbers constantly appears in all the Infrastructure Demons have infiltrated since the War began. Is this some kind of code, some hint at the God-Machine's plans? Or is the big machine finally just cracking under its own weight? And what about talk of humans designing codebreaking machines? What could that mean to the Unchained?
- Beast: The Beast Remembers (Satanic Ritual Abuse Panic of the 80s/90s). It all started with a single person claiming to remember satanic abuse, claiming the memory came to her in a dream. A dark ritual, presided over by a man in red robes. But it never happened. At least, it never *really* happened. The nightmare was certainly traumatic, but it was just that. As a result of her nightmare, however, the world became obsessed with ritual abuse, and anyone who seemed to fit the profile was hounded mercilessly. This was a time of near-extinction for the Begotten, as nightmares of hungry Horrors feeding would be misinterpreted as "buried memories," and those who could be linked to them would then receives a swift, showy trial and be shoved off to jail or worse. How will you feed your hunger, and can you avoid being the target of a witch hunt in the most Hero-filed time in United States history?
- Probably a chapter for Immortals, and maybe one centered on Inferno, but I don't have any ideas formed in my head.

Genius: the Transgression 2E is a thing that's being worked on.

👍 7

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Malkydel
Member

Join Date: Jan 2015
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06-22-2015, 01:36 PM #15

Bonus points for riffing off of THE LEGENDARY JOURNEYS there 😉.

My personal idea for Scottish Hunter was:

"Personally, for me (as a Scotsman), on the one hand it's one of those areas of history that very rarely gets attention- and when it does it tends to be handled rather badly. We're talking about events that have this profound sense of upheaval, a feeling that hasn't entirely evaporated even by the present day.

There's the rich and varied tapestry of the Scottish landscape, a place where numerous evils could hide. The hills and glens, the caves and the deeps of Lochs. The perpetual shadows of a land so wild, and a people so spirited, that even Rome couldn't tame her. Perhaps the Compacts rose from humble beginnings, the spirited warriors who kept home and hearth safe in the long watches of the night. But such things are conventional evils, no true match for the ambitions of men and the politics of beasts.

Do Vampires control the fate of nations? Do they pit England and Scotland against one another for petty gains? Wolves run the land amidst the tumult of war, battlefields draw those who seek the unquiet dead. These things and stranger horrors surface, in the chaos of conflict.
Did the Stone of Destiny hold any true power? Why was it a Spider that inspired Robert the Bruce?

I like the idea of having the Guardians of Scotland as a low-powered conspiracy or as a high-powered local Compact; looking to protect Scotland from threats

both external and internal, both mundane and supernatural. Potentially from dark powers that have dwelt in the land since ages long gone past. Maybe a nod or two to the oWoD, given its penchant for having unfathomable gribblyness in ye olde Caledonia "

"The phrase 'flies on the heads of pins' appeared 43 times in that journal, sometimes in the middle of sentences or written in the margins."

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